3063

# Executive Order

**Withdrawing from the United States Shipping Board Emergency Fleet Corporation Certain Powers With Reference to the Emergency Shipping Fund and Delegating Such Powers to the Secretary of War.**

WHEREAS, heretofore, by two Executive Orders respectively numbered 2664, dated July 11, 1917, and numbered 3018, dated December 3, 1918, I delegated to the United States Shipping Board Emergency Fleet Corporation all the power and authority vested in me under certain laws establishing, enlarging and maintaining the Emergency Shipping Fund, in so far as such power and authority had reference to activities which might be directly or indirectly applicable to ship or plant construction; and

WHEREAS, said Fleet Corporation in pursuance of such power and authority, so delegated, and at my request, has entered into certain contracts for the construction of nineteen river barges and is now planning the construction of certain river towboats, all of said vessels being intended for use on the Mississippi River or its tributaries, and has further, at my request, in planning and in carrying out such construction, engaged the assistance of the Chief of Engineers United States Army, and has heretofore transferred to him from its funds held under such delegated power and authority the sum of $3,860,000, which sum has already been deposited by the Chief of Engineers in the Treasury of the United States to the credit of the War Department;

Now,—in order to confirm the informal withdrawal from said Fleet Corporation and the informal delegation to the War Department, as effected by the acts above recited, of such part of my said power and authority as relates to such barges and towboats:

(1) I hereby withdraw from the United States Shipping Board Emergency Fleet Corporation such part of said power and authority, vested in me by said laws with reference to activities which may be directly or indirectly applicable to ship or plant construction, as relates to the construction of such nineteen river barges and such towboats, and as relates to the sum of $3,860,000 out of the funds heretofore appropriated under said laws for the construction of ships; and do hereby delegate the power and authority so withdrawn to the Secretary of War, to be by him executed through contract or otherwise as in his judgment may be most economical and advantageous to the United States.

(2) I hereby ratify said payment by said Fleet Corporation to said Chief of Engineers of the sum of $3,860,000 from said Emergency Shipping Fund out of the appropriations heretofore made by the Congress for the construction of ships.

(3) I do hereby direct that the said Fleet Corporation shall forthwith transfer and assign to the Secretary of War any and all contracts heretofore entered into by the said Fleet Corporation for or on account of the construction of such barges or towboats, and shall perform such other acts in pursuance of such transfer and assignment as will effectuate the intent of this order.

**WOODROW WILSON**

THE WHITE HOUSE,
*12 March, 1919.*

[No. 3063.]